

Wireshark

- Graphical user interface (GUI)
- Real-time packet visualization with color coding
- Deep protocol dissection with expandable trees
- Ideal for detailed, interactive analysis
- Provides statistics, flow graphs, and conversation views

Similarities

- Both capture and analyze network packets
- Both are open-source and widely used in cybersecurity

tcpdump

- Command-line only
- Lightweight and ideal for remote servers
- Faster for quick captures and automation
- Outputs plain text instead of visual protocol trees
- Preferred for scripting and incident response on headless systems
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